A Railway Settlement

> Jamalpur is the headquarters of the East India Railway. This, in itself, is not a startling statement. The wonder begins with the exploration of Jamalpur, which is a station entirely made by, and devoted to, the use of those untiring servants of the public, the railway folk. They have towns of their own at Toondla and Assensole; a sun-dried sanitarium at Bandikui; and Howrah, Ajmir, Allahabad, Lahore, and Pindi know their colonies. But Jamalpur is unadulteratedly 'Railway', and he who has nothing to do with the EI Railway in some shape or another feels a stranger and an interloper.

[Kipling's work *Kim* was published in 1901. This is a passage describing a train journey. The lama is on a pilgrimage and meets Kim, a beggar boy, who decides to accompany him. This is at the Lahore station.]

Extract from *Kim* , Chapter 2

> 'This is where the fire-carriages come. One stands behind that hole,' Kim pointed to the ticket office, 'who will give thee a paper to take thee to Umballa.'
>
> 'But we go to Benares,' he replied petulantly.
>
> 'All one. Benares then. Quick: she comes!'
>
> 'Take thou the purse.'
>
> The lama, not so well used to trains as he had pretended, started as the 3.25 a.m. south-bound roared in. The sleepers sprang to life, and the station filled with clamour and shoutings, cries of water and sweetmeat vendors, shouts of native policemen, and shrill yells of women gathering up their baskets, their families, and their husbands.
>
> The lama thinks they are travelling to Benares, but Kim wants them to stop in Umballa first.
>
> 'It is the train—only the te-rain. It will come here. Wait!' Amazed at the lama's immense simplicity (he had handed him a small bag full of rupees), Kim asked and paid for a ticket to Umballa. A sleepy clerk grunted and flung out a ticket to the next station, just six miles distant.
>
> 'Nay,' said Kim, scanning it with a grin. 'This may serve for farmers, but I live in the city of Lahore. It was cleverly done, babu. Now give the ticket to Umballa.'
>
> The babu scowled and dealt the proper ticket. [114]

BOAT TRAINS ACROSS THE SUBCONTINENT

Some of the most prestigious trains of the British era ran from Peshawar or Lahore to Mumbai to facilitate the movement of British troops and civilians. Ambitious Punjabis, too, took these trains to reach Mumbai in order to further sail to London to take the civil service examinations. [115]

Bombay to Karachi and Peshawar by Train